Mirza. They were decapitated and their heads were carried to Shaybāni Khān in Pul-i-Sālār.

Babur Sets Out for Qandahār

Shaybāni's terror reigned high within the whole Tīmūrid clan. Shāh Beg and his younger brother Muḥammad Muqīm, perplexed by the probable attack by Shaybāni, sent envoys to Babur. Those envoys carried letters reminding them of duty, a sign of amity and good wishes. In one of the letters personally written by Muqīm, he explicitly invited Babur to stand by them. By reading the letters and messages conveyed by the envoys, Babur was convinced that the Shāh Beg and Muqīm were looking upon him with hope. Babur went on to consult with the begs and counsellors. It was concluded in the following manner:[*]

> We were to get an army to horse, join the Arghūn begs and decide in accord and agreement with them, whether to move into Khurāsān or elsewhere as might seem good.

Ḥabība Sulṭān Begum (Babur addressed her as aunt) met the convoy of Babur in Ghaznī. She had come from Herī accompanied by Khusrau Kūkūldāsh, Sulṭān Qulī Chūnāq and Gadāī Balāl to make arrangements to bring her daughter Maṣ'ūma Sulṭān Begum. They too were seeking refuge in the might of Babur after having not been given a place with Ibn-i-ḥusain Mīrzā and Abū'l-muḥsin Mīrzā.

Babur's army came across a mass of traders from Hindustan in Qalāt. Perhaps they were stuck because of the riads of Aūzbegs. Babur's men were of clear opinion that they should be plundered for they were in enemies' territory, but Babur didn't approve of it. He says, 'What is the traders' offence? If we, looking to God's pleasure, leave such scrapings of gain aside, the Highest God will apportion our reward. It is now just as it was a short time back when we rode out to raid the Ghiljī; many of you then were of one mind to raid the Mahmand Afghāns, their sheep and goods, their wives, and families, just because they were within five miles of you! Then as now, I did not agree with you. On the very next day the Highest God apportioned you more sheep belonging to Afghān enemies than had ever before fallen to the share of the army.'

Having said that Babur went ahead to collect a small *peshkash* (offering) which was taken from each trader after dismounting on the other side of Qalāt. It was then that the following two Mīrzās joined them fleeing from Qandahār: